

fridayReview

THE HINDU

On Syama Sastri's works

R.K. Shriramkumar's lec-dem unravelled the nuances of the composer's kritis **p2**

Reviews of Tamil plays

Come summer, sabhas host theatre festivals where new works are staged **p3**



WHAT MICHAEL REVEALS ABOUT MICHAEL JACKSON

The recently released biographical film shows the humane side of the pop icon **p5**



Pitch-perfect portraits

When photographing legendary musicians, Raghu Rai became a rasika, experiencing the moment before capturing it

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Framed legacy Raghu Rai's 1988 photograph of veena maestro S. Balachander, shot at Mahabalipuram.

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Aishwarya Raghunathan

Next year marks 200 years since Syama Sastri (1762-1827) left this world. Yet, his kriti ‘O jagadamba’ still anchors many concerts. Though no one insists, it is simply sung. This paradox formed the core of R.K. Shriramkumar’s recent lec-dem, organised by Kedaram Trust, at Ragasudha Hall. Supporting him in this reflective presentation were vocalist Amirtha Murali, violinist Madan Mohan, mridangist K. Arunprakash and Nanditha Kannan (tambura and vocal).

Born in Tiruvarur into a family of Kamakshi archakas, Syama Sastri inherited a life devoted to worship. After political upheaval, his family brought the Bangaru Kamakshi idol to Thanjavur, where the Maratha court built them a temple (on West Main Street) and agrahara homes. Syama Sastri’s house, behind that temple, still stands in its original Maratha style – a preservation Shriramkumar praised. Syama Sastri was the first musician in the family and trained under Sangita Swami and then Pachimiriyam Adiappayya.

One of the Carnatic Trinity, around 70 of Syama Sastri’s compositions survive, which include

The grammar of devotion

Senior musician and scholar R.K. Shriramkumar on the lyrical and technical intricacies of Syama Sastri’s kritis

kritis, varnams, gitams and swarajathis. “Every composition is a masterpiece and the tone is that of a child addressing its mother. The mother-child relationship has no protocol. Sarvassvaadhinam – complete freedom. This bhava is the highlight of his works,” said Shriramkumar.

Syama Sastri carried the Goddess everywhere, and She carried him in return. The raga Chintamani tells that tale – a prayer composed in response to Bobbili Kesavayya’s challenge, performed in a rare pallavi in Sarabhanandana tala, and said to have turned a musical contest by divine grace

The bulk of the evening’s technical analysis concerned

Anandabhairavi, which Shriramkumar identified as Syama Sastri’s raga. “He has defined the raga so thoroughly that it is impossible to study it independently of his kritis. The raga’s grammar was explained not as a scale to memorise but as a set of characteristic movements to internalise.”

To understand Anandabhairavi, one must listen to Syama Sastri’s kritis such as ‘O jagadamba’, ‘Marivere’, and ‘Pahi sri girirajasute’.

‘O jagadamba’ was the evening’s centrepiece. Shriramkumar showed how the movement of the pallavi and the anupallavi is special. The pallavi rests in the middle octave, and the anupallavi has an unintuitive start from the aadhara shadjam. The

chittaswaras were demonstrated by him in detail, followed by an important message: “Ragas such as Anandabhairavi should be understood beyond its arohana-avarohana structure.”

Syama Sastri’s use of tala is among the most discussed aspects of his compositional method. Shriramkumar observed how the composer intelligently handles the intricacies of tala, a unique usage being the layering of the sahitya in a Chatusra mode over the tala that is in Tisra nadai. ‘Parvati ninnu’ in raga Kalgada is a fine example.

The text falls into a three-count lilt so naturally in Tisra Nadai that any other nadai feels like an imposition. “I could set this to Chatusra nadai. It

would fit. But it would feel wrong and forced. In Tisra Nadai, the words simply are the tala. That is sahitya-pradhaanam.”

In contrast, Misra Chapu (seven beats) is used in multiple kritis, each time with a different internal layering, showing a variety of edupu. For instance, in ‘Marivere gati’ (Anandabhairavi), the swaras create a four-count feel within the seven-beat tala. The four-against-seven creates a rhythmic polytonality – two metres heard simultaneously – that is exhilarating without being disorienting. Similarly, in ‘Talli ninnu nera’ (Kalyani) he gives different facets of Misra chapu.

In ‘Maayamma’, the sahitya takes precedence and Ahiri goes along with it. Similarly, ‘Parvati ninnu’ (Kalgada), stands as a classic example of how Syama Sastri lets the text dictate the course of the music.

Other rare talas include Kanda Mattya (‘Parvati janani bhavani’, gitam), Kanda Jhampa (‘Sariyavaramma’) and Tisra Triputa (‘Neelayadakshi’ in Paraju). Each one

Syama Sastri’s use of tala is among the most discussed aspects of his compositional method

Insightful R.K. Shriramkumar with Amirtha Murali (vocal); K. Arunprakash (mridangam); Madan Mohan (violin) and Nandita Kannan (tambura).
PHOTO: B. VELANKANNI RAJ

was demonstrated with the corresponding music, and in each case the conclusion was the same: the tala arises from the text, not the other way round.

The three Swarajathis in Bhairavi, Thodi, and Yadhukula Kamboji represent, in Shriramkumar’s view, Syama Sastri’s ultimate achievement: compositions in which the structural logic, the raga bhava and the prayer-text are so completely fused that they cannot be separated.

In the Bhairavi swarajathi, it is interesting that Syama Sastri adapts only the shuddha dhaivatam in the charanam beginning with the dhaivatam.

In the Yadhukula Kamboji swarajathi, there is no Kakali Nishadam anywhere in the swara passages. This was demonstrated with striking clarity.

The Thodi swarajathi is matchless in the pattern of *poruthams*.

“There is so much more to say about swarajathis alone. We have barely touched upon varnams – the Anandabhairavi varnam on Varadaraja Perumal, the Sowrashtra varnam and the tana varnam-style Begada varnam on Kamakshi. He composed a kriti on Subramanya swami of Vaitheeshwaran Kovil. There are kritis addressed to Devi at every major kshetra of the region – Kamakshi in Kanchipuram, Akhilandeswari in Tiruvanaikaval, Neelayatakshi, Meenakshi in Madurai, Brihannayaki in Thanjavur, Brihathamba in Pudukkottai and Dharma Samvardini in Tiruvaiyaru. All of this would take many more evenings,” said Shriramkumar.

He ended with a simple message: “Raga is an experience. For a complete understanding of a raga, listen and internalise the compositions, especially of the Trinity.”

From screen to stage

Y.Gee. Mahendra’s new play *Varadu Kutty* is a sequel to Sivaji Ganesan’s popular film *Paritchaikku Neramachu*

Suganthy Krishnamachari

The film *Paritchaikku Neramachu*, ended in a devastating tragedy. Varadu Kutty, the lovable duffer who is Sivaji’s biological son, dies in a road accident, and so does his foster son, Anand. UAA’s play *Varadu Kutty-Paritchaikku Neramachu 2* (story -G. Radhakrishnan; core idea- Sureshwar; direction- Y.Gee. Mahendra) picks up where the film left off.

Y.Gee. Mahendra reprises the role of Varadu Kutty, which he played in the film. Varadu’s agitated soul hasn’t left the earth, as he died before fulfilling his father’s ambition of seeing his son pass the Public Service examination. So, Varadu’s spirit now wants to help a mediocre student do well in



his board exams. Devaram (Karthik Aridhara) fits the bill, for he has failed his Plus Two exams thrice. Varadu goes on to explain how he himself suddenly became smart – during one of his visits to the realm of souls, he happened to meet the mathematician Srinivasa Ramanujan, and managed to imbibe his brilliance. So, armed with his newfound abilities Varadu becomes

Devaram’s teacher. Of course, nobody except Devaram can see him.

While this premise offered ample scope for humour, the play didn’t quite capitalise on it, with most of these scenes remaining tepid.

The character of Cheenu (Sureshwar), as the perpetually inebriated brother-in-law of Devaram, had no relevance to the

story and tested one’s patience. The transition from one scene to the other was not seamless, creating a choppy effect. A more focused script would have helped.

The opening song (music V. Balasubramaniam; singer Ritvik) was catchy. The politically-charged dialogue and Varadu’s pungent wit went down well with the audience. Reminiscing about his romantic salad days, his father’s plans for his future and an occasional air of mock seriousness as he delivered his witticisms, Y. Gee. Mahendra’s performance was lively and engaging. There was a twist in the story towards the end, which, until then, was on expected lines. Kartik Aridhara is an actor to watch out for. Did ‘Varadu Kutty’ pass muster? Yes, but only just.

CULTUREBRIEFS



Dedicated to Adi Sankara

The 2,535th Jayanti of Adi Sankara – Vaishaka Shukla Panchami – was celebrated by Sri Bhagavadpadal Paramparakadha Moolamnaya Sarvagna Kanchi Kamakoti Pitam on April 21. This annual event, a 120-year-old tradition, was started by Sri Chandrasekharendra Saraswati, the 68th pontiff.

In a short life span of 32 years, Adi Sankara travelled across the country by foot to propagate the Advaita philosophy. He had composed numerous seminal works and won many debates, leaving behind a rich literary treasure. Festivities in connection with his Jayanti, which began on April 17, coincided with the completion of one year of sanyasrama by Sri Satya Chandrasekharendra Saraswati, the 71st pontiff.

The ivory image of Adi Sankara was taken out in a procession for abhishekam at various temple tanks, one on each day – Sarva Tirtam, Upanishad Braharendra Matam, Sri Kachabeswara temple, and the Pancha Ganga Tirtham at Sri Kamakshi Ambal temple. The series of rituals culminated on Sankara Jayanti, marked by special pujas and abhishekam at the Mangala Tirtham. In the early hours of the same day, special abhishekam and pujas were performed to the 60-ft Eka-shila vighraha (monolithic statue) of Adi Sankara at Sri Chandrasekharendra Saraswathi Viswa Mahavidyalaya, Enathur. The Jayanti celebrations also featured the annual Veda Poorti Pariksha convocation, when 145 young vidyarthi received certificates. The Vedic convocation is held twice in a year - on Sankara Jayanti and Vijayadasami. The convocation was held under the auspices of the Veda Rakshana Nidhi Trust at Srimatam, Kanchipuram. The Trust was set up in 1963 under the guidance of Mahaperiyava.

CALENDAR

Tribute to Dikshitar

Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan, Chennai Kendra, presents Gayathri Girish’s concert titled ‘Hidden Gems in Muthuswami Dikshitar Compositions’ on May 3 (10 a.m.) at its main auditorium, Mylapore.

Celebrating Tyagaraja

Madhuradhwani will feature the following concerts on the occasion of Tyagaraja’s 258th jayanti celebrations. May 3, 6.15 p.m.: Pantula Rama’s Ekaika raga kritis. May 4, 6.15 p.m.: Erode Balaji discourse ‘Tyagaraja Anubhavam’. Venue: Arkay Convention Centre.

HCL concert

The Music Academy has organised B. Sai Harinni’s veena recital on May 4, 6 p.m., at the Kasturi Srinivasan Hall. She will be accompanied by K.P.S. Kathikeya Adinarayana Sarma (mridangam) and Samyuktha Sreeram (ghatam).



Spotlight on Tamil kritis

Mudhra presents ‘Chithirai Isai Vizha’, from today. The festival streams concerts until May 6 (6.30 p.m.) on www.paalamt.com

This is the fifth edition of the festival, which features more than 70 Tamil compositions.

Schedule: May 1: Sai Vignesh (vocal) with Pappu Gnyandev (violin), Melakaveri Balaji (mridangam). May 2: Maalavika Sundar (vocal) with Thirucherai Karthik (violin) and Guru Raghavendra (mridangam). May 3: Santhosh Subramanian (vocal), accompanied by M. Vijay (violin) and Mannarkoil J. Balaji (mridangam). May 4: R.P. Shravan (vocal) will be accompanied by Chidambaram Badrinath on the violin and Nellai Balaji on the mridangam. May 5: Madhu Iyer (vocal) with Gayatri Vibhavari (violin) and Ambur Padmanabhan (mridangam). The series concludes on May 6 with Nachikethan Vivek Srinivasan’s vocal concert. He will be accompanied by Karaikal Venkatasubramanian (violin), Arjun Ganesh (mridangam) and Trichy K. Murali (ghatam).



A well-scripted play

Yamini Yen Kanmani blends humour and satire effortlessly

Suganthy Krishnamachari

Kodai Nataka Vizha 2026, hosted by Kartik Fine Arts, began with Sathya Sai Creations’ *Yamini Yen Kanmani* (direction by Mapillai Ganesh). Ezhichur Aravindan (scriptwriter) handles humour well, and he did not disappoint this time

too. Things move on smoothly in Panchapakesan’s (Ezhichur Aravindan) family, except for minor quarrels between his daughter Arunachalam (Mapillai Ganesh) plans to destroy Panchapakesan’s mental peace. Troubles ensue when Yamini enters the scene,

claiming to be Panchapakesan’s daughter. Because Panchapakesan once gave in to his passion years ago, there is a possibility that she may be his daughter, and so he is unable to turn her away.

As if there is not enough confusion, Kandasamy’s soft corner for any woman named Yamini only worsens the situation. And, Yamini’s love for Rishi (Prasanth), the nephew of a politician, only deepens the tangle.

As in all of Aravindan’s plays, there were many farcical misunderstandings in the story, and as always, he deftly untied all the knots in

the last scene. The entire cast performed well, particularly Devika as Krishnaveni and Malini Devi as Yamini.

With changes in vocal inflection and perfect timing, K.S. Palani as Gas Kesavan, the politician, had the audience in splits. His hilarious take on the current political scene and digs at well-known politicians did not leave anyone in doubt about who the targets were. Kesavan is delighted when he discovers that his nephew Rishi will do anything for money, and says he will make a good politician.

The play took a swipe at those who expect every play to convey some message, and at the end of the play, each character came up with a different message that the play was supposed to convey. The overall message, of course, was that a clear conscience makes a soft pillow. *Yamini Yen Kanmani* was well-directed, and a good, clean fun.

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Frozen in time (Clockwise from right) Raghu Rai's photographs of M.S. Subbulakshmi; Pt. Hariprasad Chaurasia; Ustad Alla Rakha and Ustad Zakir Hussain; Ustad Vilayat Khan; Ustad Bismillah Khan; Pt. Kumar Gandharva and Pt. Bhimsen Joshi.



RAGHU RAI | 1942 - 2026

Pitch-perfect portraits

Rithvik Raja

For many years before I met Raghu Rai, I encountered him through his images. My first introduction to his work came through his extraordinary photographs of India's great classical musicians – M.S. Subbulakshmi, Pt Bhimsen Joshi, Ustad Bismillah Khan, Ustad Vilayat Khan, Pt. Ravi Shankar, Pt. Hariprasad Chaurasia, Kishori Amonkar and several others. The images did not merely document their performances, but held something far more elusive: spirit, surrender, divinity and life itself. They became my doorway into his vast body of work. And through them, I began to understand why Raghu Rai's photography occupies such an unparalleled place in India's cultural memory.

He never confined himself to one genre, style or specialisation. He photographed what moved him – history, politics, suffering, music, spirituality and daily life. Photography, for him, was not simply a craft or profession, it was the way he understood existence itself. This philosophy became clear to me when I had the privilege of spending two full days with him in Chennai last year. In those 48 hours, I found myself returning to his photographs of India's music legends – the images that had first drawn me to him. What moved me deeply was how vividly he remembered those moments.

Raghu Rai spoke of his iconic photograph of M.S. Subbulakshmi as one of his

favourites and how he rarely moved close to a subject's face. But with M.S., he came to realise that her essence – her divinity – radiated most powerfully in a close-up. He had tried before to capture that quality and felt he had failed. Only later did he understand that he had to wait, not merely for expression, but for the precise moment when her music and spirit shone as one upon her face. And so he waited, watched and clicked only when he felt that divinity emerge. That patience, that surrender to the truth of the moment reveals everything about his artistic philosophy.

When I first met him at Marina Beach for a shoot he had invited me for, I was overwhelmed. Standing before someone whose work had shaped so much of how I had learned to see felt almost unreal. But within moments, I realised that my awe, words or even my identity were irrelevant to him in that space. Once he began shooting, everything else ceased to exist. It was just him, his camera and the moment unfolding before him.

I simply had to do what I do – sing. And that was enough. Only after the shoot did he connect with me personally – with warmth, curiosity and openness. He did not speak from the stature of a legend, but with the humility of someone still learning. It was this constant seeking that kept him youthful, and kept his art forever vital.

Among my personal favourites is his series on Ustad Bismillah Khan. It reveals the man behind the maestro. One particularly striking image shows him

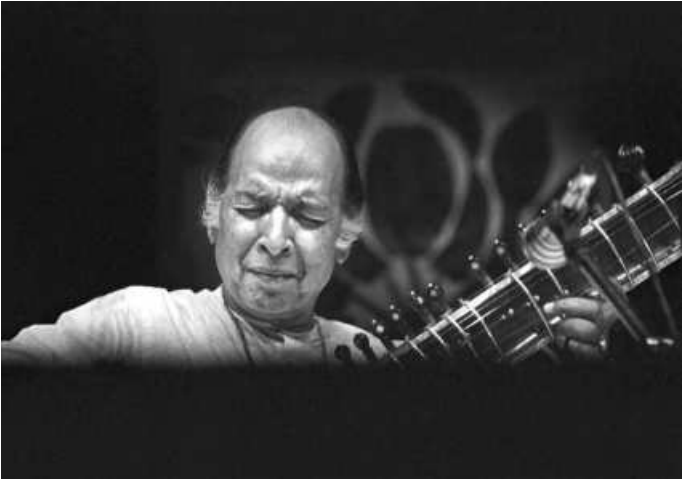


seated in quiet reflection, cigarette in hand. There is no attempt to edit. The complexities of life remain intact. Raghu Rai did not seek artificially clean frames or orchestrated perfection. He wanted life as it was – its textures, imperfections, surroundings and emotional residue. This, perhaps, is what made his images so enduringly alive. He did not isolate his subjects from their worlds; he allowed their worlds to breathe through them. He understood deeply that "chaos is not the same as tension."

Raghu Rai also spoke with

admiration about S. Balachander, whose music he had discovered through a mutual friend in Delhi. Struck by Balachander's fearless genius, which he likened to that of Mali – another artiste he revered, whose Kapi and Jonpuri he kept going back to – Raghu Rai fondly recalled photographing the veena exponent at Mahabalipuram. He felt that the monumental scale of the ancient structures matched the immensity of Balachander's artistry.

During a studio shoot, he first asked me to sing. As I sang Kapi, one of his favourite



ragas, he responded not merely as a photographer but as a rasika. When a phrase moved him, his hand would enter the frame in appreciation, becoming part of the visual language. Raghu Rai had the ability to experience the emotion before he photographed.

Pt. Kumar Gandharva, too, was close to his heart. Kumarji's haunting rendition of 'Ud jayega' was his ringtone. His photographs of the legendary vocalist at his home in Dewas are deeply intimate. But one performance image remains unforgettable, where

Kumar Gandharva's hands become poetry in motion. Through an uncanny visual instinct, Raghu Rai blacks out the proscenium, stripping away distraction to bring the gesture and expression into sharp focus. For many of us, who never witnessed these legends perform, his images are more than photographs – they are enduring memories, forever shaping how we imagine them as we listen.

Raghu Rai was never in a hurry. Even in the digital era, he did not believe in endless, indiscriminate shooting or relying on post-production to

discover meaning later. If he did not feel the image in the moment, it was discarded right there. Such certainty could only come from profound observation, patience and trust in instinct.

The same can be said of his photograph of Pt. Bhimsen Joshi – neck arched skyward in complete physical surrender to *sur*. Anyone who has witnessed Bhimsenji perform knows how deeply embodied his music was. Raghu Rai's remarkable series on Ustad Alla Rakha and Ustad Zakir Hussain similarly reveals his unmatched ability to photograph rhythm itself. In one image, the father and son mirror one another's artistry stroke by stroke. Sound becomes motion. Motion becomes memory.

His advice to young photographers reflected the same ethos. At a workshop I attended in Chennai, he urged participants to occasionally leave their cameras behind – to simply sit in public spaces, observe people and learn to "see".

Among the many invaluable memories I carry is the piece of advice he shared after hearing me sing: "Your calling is always within you. It will guide your path. Trust it. Listen to it."

To me, Raghu Rai's greatness lay not only in the monumental archive he leaves behind, but in the way he lived every day – with fierce presence, emotional depth and an insatiable hunger to feel life fully.

(The writer is a well-known Carnatic musician)



V.V. Ramani

This was an idea that germinated during the period of isolation when people began focussing on their physical and mental well-being – leading to the conceptual work 'Shatripu-Aaru Pagaigal'. Written by Nirmala Nagarajan, with music composition by Vanathi Raghuraman, swara composition by Shanta Dhananjayan and special jatis and natya composition by V.P. Dhananjayan, this work explores the six emotional states of the human mind. Dancers Uttiya Barua and

Accent on emotions

Shatripu moved beyond mythological narratives to explore six states of the human mind

Sivadas Rajan performed 'Shatripu' at Bharata Kalanjali recently.

Kkamam (lust), krodham (anger), moham (greed), lobham (miserliness), madham (arrogance) and matsaryam (jealousy) – were showcased through anecdotes, stories and experiences.

The dancers transitioned from one

emotion to the other seamlessly, alternating between solo depiction and duet dialogue. The music composition included ragas such as Kanada, Kuntalavarali and Mukhari, which were used to depict six states of the mind. The lyrics in the form of short couplets were easy to comprehend. Verses, swaras and jathis were interwoven

thoughtfully to form an engaging soundscape.

The choreography was designed to resonate with adults and children alike. For instance, 'krodham' was shown through the Panchatantra tale, *The Snake and The Mongoose*, where the woman, blinded by rage, kills the loyal mongoose that saved her child from a snake. It communicated powerfully

the need for caution and the perils of acting on an impulse. For 'madham', they drew on the arrogance that can surface in a student-teacher relationship, and how it can affect the bond.

Greed and jealousy were conveyed through interactions between the dancers, who assumed different characters effortlessly. The dancers donned the roles of politicians to portray greed, lending the performance a contemporary relevance. The nritya elements in a sawaal-jawab pattern was effective in conveying friction and jealousy

between two dancers, who are also competitors. Though reminiscent of the popular *Vanjikottai Valiban* song, the segment didn't quite make an impact. In some segments, such as 'moham' and 'lobham', the abhinaya and movement seemed to overlap, making it difficult to differentiate the emotions.

Shatripu was an interesting concept. It moved away from the routine format of sringara and bhakti, usually depicted through mythological stories. However, a more expansive treatment and a slower pace would have augured well for the production.

Rachel Rhine

Watching *Michael*, the recently released biographical film directed by Antoine Fuqua, what lingers isn't just the music or the performance, but a striking awareness of how early everything began for Michael Jackson. By the time most artists are still discovering themselves, he had already been shaped by years of rehearsals, recordings and constant exposure. The film shows glimpses of this, but looking back, it's difficult not to think about what it would have meant to grow up under that kind of pressure, and how much of it impacted his later life.

When you talk about Michael Jackson today, one usually jumps straight to the magnitude of what he accomplished. *Thriller* remains the most vivid example, with an estimated 70 million copies sold worldwide, that numbers don't fully explain why his work continues to resonate.

Take *Billie Jean*, which has crossed a billion streams on Spotify. Listening to it today, what's striking is not just its familiarity, but how controlled it feels – the bassline moves with consistency,



King of pop Michael Jackson's genius remains unmatched; and (below left) Jaafar Jackson as Michael Jackson in a scene from the film. PHOTOS: REUTERS, AP AND SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

the drums stay tight and his voice sits carefully within that structure. There's very little excess; everything feels intentional, marked by a sense of precision that extends to his performance as well. It's easy to focus on the iconic elements – the moonwalk and the spins. But what holds everything together is the discipline behind them. The film shows how movements are refined

until they land exactly where they should, pauses are measured, and even the stillness becomes part of the performance. What looks effortless on stage is built through a process of relentless rigour.

A lot of what pop music is now – the expectation that an artiste sing, dance and deliver a visually cohesive performance – can be attributed to this iconic trendsetter. The ‘Thriller’ video, with its narrative structure and cinematic ambition, redefined how music could be presented.

What's particularly interesting is how well all of this holds up in the present, especially given how differently music is consumed today. Songs rarely arrive as part of a



complete album experience. They appear in fragments, through playlists, short clips or algorithm-driven recommendations. In this environment, a lot of older music loses some of its impact, because it depends on context or buildup.

Michael Jackson's work, however, doesn't quite fall into that category. A single section of a song, or even a brief clip of a performance, often carries enough clarity and precision to stand on its own. That's why his catalogue continues to reach new listeners. His songs still generate millions of streams each year, and that kind of consistency suggests that they are being actively chosen, not simply revisited out of nostalgia.

At the same time, focusing only on the music and the performance risks missing another important aspect of who he was. Michael Jackson's position allowed him to operate on a scale that few artists ever reach. He did try to use that reach in ways that extended beyond his own work. The most obvious example is 'We Are the World', which he co-wrote with Lionel Richie. The recording brought together major artists, including Stevie Wonder and Bruce Springsteen, at a time when collaborations of that scale were far less common. The song went on to raise over 80 million dollars for famine relief in Africa, but beyond the amount, it demonstrated an ability to bring people together for a shared cause.

None of this makes Michael Jackson easier to define. The same person, who approached music and performance with exacting discipline, was also searching for moments or spaces that felt free from pressure. That tension sits at the centre of how he is remembered, and it's part of what makes him continue to feel relevant in ways that go beyond his achievements.

The release of *Michael* makes you realise how often you have been encountering versions of what he created without naming it – in the way songs are structured, performances are staged, or how artists think about their role beyond making music. That, more than anything, explains why he doesn't feel distant.

CALENDAR

Brahmotsavam

The 11-day festival at Arulmigu Parthasarathy Swami Temple, Triplicane, began yesterday. The processional deity will be taken out on different mounts on each day of the festival, which concludes on May 10. Garuda sevai is on May 3, 5 a.m. Temple 'ther' festival is on May 7.

The vidyatri utsavam will be held from May 11 to 18 with the deity being taken out in a procession on pushpa pallakku on the last day of the utsavam.



PHOTO: R. RAGU

Music and lecture



Bhavya Hari. May 7, 6.15 p.m.: Mylai Karthikeyan (nagaswaram) with Akkarai Sornalatha on the violin, Sree Sundarkumar on the mridangam and B.S. Purushotham on the kanjira.

Under the auspices of Madhuradhwani the following programmes will be held at Arkay Convention Centre, Mylapore. Details: May 6, 6.15 p.m.: Tiruvachagam discourse series by Madhusudhanan Kalaiselvan with vocalists

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Annual festival

As part of the Panguni utsavam, the annual temple ther festival at Arulmigu Adipuriswarar temple, in Chindatripet, took place on April 28.

Dedicated to
Annamayya

Sarvani Sangeetha Sabha Trust has organised a thematic concert featuring the compositions of Annamacharya and saint poetess Tarigonda Vengamamba on May 3, 6.15 p.m., at Ragasudha Hall, Luz, Mylapore. Nihal Konduri, Sumanas Sharma Kasula, B. Lalitha Madhav, Bhuvanagiri Vishnu Priya and Sudarshan will render the kriti. Gayathri Vibhahari Vyakaranam will accompany them on the violin, Ajeeth Sridhar on the mridangam and S. Jaikishan on the ghatam.

Namasankirtanam

The Music Academy will feature V. Karthick Gnaneshwar's namasankirtanam on May 7, 6 p.m., at the Kasturi Srinivasan Hall. The programme is being held under the endowment instituted by Abhang artiste Ganesh Kumar, in memory of Swami Haridhoss Giri.

Narasimha jayanti

Pudukkottai Lakshmi Narasimha Jayanthi Trust is celebrating the 107th Sri Lakshmi Nrusimha jayanti mahotsavam until May 4 at Poojyasri Gopalakrishna Bhagavathaswami Namasankeerthana Mandapam, T.S.No. 2990, East 3rd Street, Pudukkottai. The five-day festival, which began yesterday, will include sampradaya bhajan, divyanamam, dolotsavam, Sita kalyanam, and Akanda Ramanama Vaibhavam. Anjaneya utsavam will be performed on May 3 at 8 p.m.



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